

MCHB FY27 Title V Block Grant Guidance

Glossary of Key Terms

PERFORMANCE MEASUREMENT FRAMEWORK

National Outcome Measures (NOMs)

Long-term indicators of health status, quality of life, preventable morbidity, and mortality for the MCH population. NOMs are tracked by MCHB using federal data sources.

Key Characteristics:

- Measured at the national level using federally available data
- Not all states have separate state-level data for every NOM
- States track NOMs to monitor impact of their NPMs and programmatic efforts
- Examples: maternal mortality rate, infant mortality rate, child accident mortality rate

National Performance Measures (NPMs)

Short-term and medium-term performance measures that utilize population-based, state-level data. NPMs track prevalence rates and measure progress toward demonstrable impact on health outcomes.

Key Characteristics:

- Population-based — derived from surveys or administrative data
- Short/medium-term outcomes — designed to show progress over 1–5 years
- State-selected — states choose which NPMs align with their priorities (with 2 Universal exceptions)
- Minimum requirement — states MUST report on a minimum of 5 NPMs, with at least 1 per MCH population domain
- Linked to ESMs — each NPM requires at least 1 Evidence-informed Strategy Measure

Universal NPMs (REQUIRED for all states)

Two specific NPMs that EVERY state must report on. Selected by MCHB for focus on access and quality of primary and preventive care.

The Two Universal NPMs:

1. Postpartum Visit (2-part measure)

A) Percent of women who attended a postpartum checkup within 12 weeks after giving birth

B) Percent of women who attended a postpartum checkup and received recommended care components

Domain(s): Women/Maternal Health, Perinatal/Infant Health

Rationale: Addresses maternal mortality and morbidity; ensures comprehensive postpartum clinical services

2. Medical Home – Overall (multi-component measure)

Percent of children with and without special health care needs, ages 0–17, who have a medical home

Domain(s): Child Health, CSHCN (must be reported in both; counts as 1 NPM toward minimum of 5)

Rationale: Ensures comprehensive and coordinated care for all children; research shows children with a medical home receive more preventive care

Discretionary NPMs

NPMs that states may voluntarily select based on their unique MCH priorities and identified needs.

Key Characteristics:

- Flexibility — Each domain offers multiple NPM options (3–7 options per domain)
- Domain-specific — Different options available for each MCH domain
- Stability — States encouraged not to change selections during 5-year cycle for trend analysis

State Performance Measures (SPMs)

State-specific measures developed by individual states to address identified priority needs NOT fully addressed by selected NPMs.

Key Characteristics:

- State-developed — each state creates its own SPMs based on needs assessment findings
- Flexible — can measure outcome, process, or structure indicators
- Priority-driven — at least one SPM for each identified priority need not covered by an NPM
- No minimum or maximum — states develop as many SPMs as needed

Evidence-informed/based Strategy Measures (ESMs)

Structural or process measures that states develop to track HOW they plan to achieve their NPMs and SPMs. ESMs measure the implementation and progress of state strategies.

Key Characteristics:

- Process/structure-focused — measure implementation steps rather than outcomes
- Actionable — within state control (states can influence ESM progress directly)
- Strategy-driven — demonstrate pathway from strategy to NPM outcome
- Measurable annually — show year-to-year progress in implementing strategies
- Required — minimum 1 ESM per NPM

Performance Measurement Framework Summary

Measure Type	Purpose	Level	Timeframe	Who Sets It	Data Source	State Requirement
NOM	Long-term health status/outcome indicator	Federal	5–20 years	MCHB	Federal databases	Track (not required)
NPM – Universal	Short/medium-term outcome for priority area (required 2)	State/Federal	1–5 years	MCHB	State + federal data	REQUIRED measure
NPM – Discretionary	Short/medium-term outcome for state priority	State/Federal	1–5 years	State	State + federal data	REQUIRED (minimum 5)
SPM	State-specific outcome for priority	State	Variable	State	State data	OPTIONAL needed
ESM	Process/implementation measure	State	1 year	State	State program data	REQUIRED per NPM

ACRONYMS & ABBREVIATIONS

CSHCN — Children with Special Health Care Needs

ESM — Evidence-informed/based Strategy Measure

MCH — Maternal and Child Health

MCHB — Maternal and Child Health Bureau (HRSA)

NOM — National Outcome Measure

NPM — National Performance Measure

SPM — State Performance Measure

NSCH — National Survey of Children's Health

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